

WALT

Walt Viviers

Senior Graphic Designer / Art Director / AI-Integrated Creative / Illustrator
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LinkedIn · Behance · Dribbble · Instagram · GitHub · waltviviers.com

PROFILE

Senior Graphic Designer and visual creative with 20 years of progressive experience — from Junior Designer to Creative Director at a leading South African digital agency. A hands-on design practitioner across brand identity, illustration, motion graphics, UI/UX, print, and digital. Early adopter and daily user of AI design tools — integrating ChatGPT, Gemini, and Deepseek into creative workflows for concepting, production, and execution. Practising fine artist (acrylic & mixed media) with a strong foundation in visual storytelling, typography, and colour theory. Co-founded and successfully exited a printing business. MEA Business Award winner.

EXPERIENCE

Creative Director · Menzies Media

Nov 2019 – Present

Full-time · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Lead the visual direction across brand identity, digital campaigns, motion graphics, UI/UX, print, and e-commerce design for major SA and international brands.
- Pitch creative concepts to clients; establish the look, feel, and graphic language for all projects from brief to final art.
- Design and art-direct the full creative suite: typography, colour, layout, illustration, photography, and motion.
- Integrate AI tools (ChatGPT, Gemini, Deepseek) daily into concepting and production workflows — reducing iteration time and expanding creative range.
- Oversee UX/UI design in Figma; direct e-commerce visual build-outs on Shopify; produce assets for Google Ads and Meta campaigns.
- Clients: Kaizer Chiefs, Alpha Industries, Kappa, Sebago, Superga, Broll Property Group, Eris Property Group, SAB, Mochachos, PrintingSA, Villas in Cape Town, Oaksure, 1.618 Group.

Art Director · Menzies Media

Jul 2016 – Oct 2019

Full-time · 3 yrs 4 mos · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Set the overall visual tone and timbre for all creative work — from colour palettes and photo shoot direction to the graphic values of websites and campaigns.
- Established conceptual and stylistic direction for design staff; participated in pitches and formal presentations to prospective clients.
- Art directed photography shoots: defined acquisition themes, styling, and visual language aligned with each brand identity.
- Developed motion-based content (After Effects, animated GIFs, video) for social media, digital campaigns, and ATL activations.
- Mentored junior designers; maintained creative quality and brand consistency across all touchpoints.

Senior Graphic Designer · Menzies Media

Jul 2012 – Jun 2016

Full-time · 4 yrs · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Took design briefs and implemented them end-to-end — viewing each project not in isolation, but as part of the client's bigger marketing picture.
- Delivered design solutions from concept to completion: rough sketches, comps, layouts, and final art, working exclusively within Adobe Creative Suite.
- Utilised photography and illustration alongside digital design to achieve the precise visual results required by each brief.
- Collaborated closely with copywriters, photographers, and sales staff on integrated campaigns across print, digital, and social.
- Built and maintained brand systems for multiple client accounts simultaneously.

Graphic Designer · Co-Founder · Bang Bang Advertising

Feb 2007 – Feb 2010

Full-time · 3 yrs · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Identified a market opportunity and co-founded a printing brokerage from the ground up.
- Built the company's operational framework, business strategy, and creative output.
- Grew the business to profitability, then successfully sold my share — a clean exit from a thriving venture.

Web Designer / Illustrator · 1985.co.za

Jan 2010 – Jul 2012

Freelance · 2 yrs 7 mos · Roodepoort, Gauteng

- Delivered web design, graphic design, and illustration projects for clients across various industries.
- Built and maintained websites; produced print collateral, digital assets, and illustrative work.

Senior Designer · Solutions Advertising

Jun 2011 – Jun 2012

Full-time · 1 yr 1 mo · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Owned visual communication strategy; created versatile design concepts across print and digital channels.

Graphic Designer · Pro Graphics

Mar 2010 – May 2011

Full-time · Randburg, Gauteng

- Translated project requirements into high-quality layouts for marketing collateral, corporate documents, and print media.

Junior Designer · GY Print

Jan 2006 – Jan 2007

Full-time · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Handled layout and production design for diverse marketing applications; ensured visual consistency and print-ready output.

Graphic & Audio/Visual Designer · Sweat Shop Productions

2006

Freelance / Self-Employed · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Writing, directing, editing, photography, poster design, DVD covers, storyboards, and multimedia design under own entity.

Graphic Designer · Stenele Bosch Africa

2006

Freelance · Architectural Practice · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Artistic impression of the Ivory Park Bridges — architectural visualisation and graphic design for a civil engineering project.

Graphic Designer · T.H.E (The Human Effect)

2005

Freelance · Music Industry

- Conceptualisation and design of CD sleeve — cover art, typography, and print layout.

Graphic Designer · Tattoo Millenium

2004

Freelance / Holiday Employment · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Logos, advertising, pamphlets, letterheads, and business cards for the studio and its clients.

Graphic / Multimedia Designer · S.A.i.N

2004

Freelance · Marketing Industry · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Logo, letterheads, and full website (sain.co.za) — visual identity and digital presence from scratch.

Graphic Designer · Umdlalo Wami

2003

Freelance · Psychology Practice · Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Full visual identity — logo, letterheads, and business cards; concept through to print-ready artwork.

Fine Artist · Freelance Designer · waltviviers.com

2010 – Present

Freelance · Pretoria, Gauteng

- Practising fine artist — acrylic & mixed media, illustration — represented on Saatchi Art; shown on Behance, Instagram, and Dribbble.
- Freelance web design, graphic design, and illustration; AI-assisted design and web workflows.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Design Software Adobe Photoshop · Adobe Illustrator · Adobe InDesign · Adobe After Effects · Adobe Premiere Pro · Figma · Canva Pro

Creative Brand Identity · Visual Design · Illustration · Motion Graphics · Animation · Typography · Colour Theory · Print Production · Art Direction · Campaign Concepting

AI Tools Claude · ChatGPT · Gemini · Deepseek · AI-assisted concepting · Prompt engineering for creative workflows · AI image direction

Web & UI UI/UX Design (Figma) · WordPress · HTML/CSS · E-Commerce (Shopify) · GitHub · Google Workspace

Digital Marketing Google Ads · Meta Business Suite · SEO/SEM · Google Analytics · Social Media Content

Languages English (fluent) · Afrikaans (fluent)

AWARDS

- Leading Pioneers in Digital Marketing — MEA Business Awards, January 2021
- Best Next-Gen Tech-Driven Marketing Company, Southern Africa — MEA Business Awards, January 2020
- Best Art / Design Student Floating Trophy — Design School S.A., January 2004

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

1st Year BA — Motion Picture: Animation, Directing & Writing · AFDA

2005

African Film and Drama Academy — South Africa's leading School of Motion Picture Medium and Live Performance. Majors: Animation (distinction) · Directing (distinction) · Writing (distinction).

Film assists: *The Karmic Obligation* · *Five Minutes*. Role: First Assistant Director — Storyboarding, Shoot Scheduling, Smooth Running of Operations.

Senior Certificate · Hoërskool Florida

2000 – 2004

Subjects: Art (distinction) · Design (distinction) · English · Afrikaans · Biology · Computer Science. Awarded The Design School S.A. Best Art/Design Student Floating Trophy 2004/5. Certificate of Merit for Art & Design.

Google / Coursera

From Likes to Leads: Interact with Customers Online *Google/Coursera, Aug 2025* ↗

Attract and Engage Customers with Digital Marketing *Google/Coursera, Jul 2025* ↗

Foundations of Digital Marketing and E-commerce *Google/Coursera, Jul 2025* ↗

Programming Hub

Digital Marketing Advanced *Programming Hub, Jan 2024* ↗

Digital Marketing *Programming Hub, Dec 2023* ↗

Material Design *Programming Hub, Dec 2023* ↗

Digital Skills: User Experience *Accenture / FutureLearn, Jul 2021* ↗

CSS Fundamentals *Sololearn, Jul 2019* ↗

HTML Fundamentals *Sololearn, Mar 2019* ↗

REFERENCES

Humphrey Mukwenga *Lead Web Developer, LSi*

“Walt is a visionary in the field of design, particularly excelling in UI/UX... What sets Walt apart is his unique blend of creativity and practicality. He not only has an eye for stunning design but also a deep understanding of the technical aspects of development.”

Kieran Pearce *Head of Digital, Waypoint Digital*

“Walt is an incredible creative, really has always gone above and beyond. His brain is really unique, and it shows in the work he produces.”

Neal Strydom *Motion Designer*

“Walt is an inspirational, down-to-earth and logical voice within the chaotic realms of creativity. I am confident that with Walt's creative and art direction, the work being produced will be of stellar quality.”

Maxime de Montbron *Cyber Security Analyst (fmr. Junior Data Scientist, Menzies Media)*

“Walt maintained the highest degree of professionalism when it came to managing his staff. His combination of creativity, intellectual ability, and people skills makes him an invaluable asset to any company.”

Leigh Munro *Graphic Designer, Paragon Banking Group PLC*

“Walt has expertise in many fields, including design, UX, animation and creative direction. He is incredibly creative and can produce high-quality concepts and designs under pressure.”

Full references at [linkedin.com/in/waltviviervs](https://www.linkedin.com/in/waltviviervs)